

HOUSE No. 3445

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Jennifer Balinsky Armini

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to promote solar panel installations on school property.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Jennifer Balinsky Armini</i>	<i>8th Essex</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 3445

By Representative Armini of Marblehead, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 3445) of Jennifer Balinsky Armini for legislation to promote solar panel installations on school property. Telecommunications, Utilities and Energy.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 3136 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to promote solar panel installations on school property.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 25A of the General Laws, as amended by section 41 of chapter 179 of the acts of
2 2022, is hereby further amended by adding the following section:-

3 Section 21. (a) The office in coordination with the department, as defined in section 3,
4 shall establish a program to promote, support and encourage the construction, installation and
5 operation of solar panels at K-12 public schools in districts across the commonwealth including,
6 municipal and state education offices. The program shall increase overall renewable energy
7 generation and improve energy efficiency through the installation of solar panels at K-12 public
8 schools.

9 (b) The program shall include:

(i) incentives to encourage the construction, installation and operation of solar panels, which may include construction requirements, incentive payments, tax reductions or deferrals, loans or grants, expedited interconnection requirements, zoning or other regulatory preferences which may include, increasing the amount of the incentive through the state's current or future solar incentive program for solar panel installation at K-12 public schools;

(ii) expanding installation of solar panels in the commonwealth;

(iii) maximizing the energy use savings of solar panels at K-12 public schools in the commonwealth;

(iv) expand the availability of solar panel electric vehicle charging infrastructure including, but not limited to: (i) technical assistance; (ii) demonstrations; and (iii) identification and implementation of cost-effective energy efficiency, energy storage and electric vehicle charging infrastructure measures and programs in existing and planned buildings or facilities of K-12 public schools in the commonwealth;

(v) roof quality evaluations when considering the installation of solar panels at K-12 public schools; and

(vi) such other criteria and conditions necessary for an efficient and effective installation of solar panels at K-12 public schools in the commonwealth.

(c) In designing the program, the department shall:

(i) consult with an advisory working group to make recommendations concerning the design and operation of the program. The members of the advisory working group shall be appointed by the secretary and shall include: (i) a representative of the department of energy

resources, who shall chair the working group; (ii) a representative of the department elementary and secondary education; (iii) a representative of organized labor; (iv) a representative of the solar energy industry; (v) a representative of an environmental group concerned with energy; (vi) a representative of the construction industry; (vii) a representative of an electric utility or organization representing electric utilities; (viii) a representative of local government in the commonwealth; (ix) a person with expertise in energy siting; and (x) a person with expertise in solar energy and energy efficiency;

(ii) review the design, installation and operation of solar panels proposed or in operation in other states;

(iii) review cost and benefit analysis of K-12 public schools leasing solar panels rather than operating solar panels;

(iv) review the federal Inflation Reduction Act of 2022 for possible funding for the installation of solar panels at K-12 public schools; and

(v) hold not fewer than 3 public hearings in different regions of the commonwealth to receive public testimony and input on the program including, but not limited to, proposals by K-12 public school districts with 1 or multiple future projects for installation of solar panels.

(d) The department shall promulgate regulations as necessary to implement the program.

(e) If statutory changes are necessary to implement the program, the department shall make specific recommendations to the general court for required changes in law.